Listening comprehension exercise

You will hear part of a radio interview with Kirsty Ross works as a television presenter. For questions 1-7 choose the best answer (A, B or C).

1) Before Kirsty became a television presenter, she was …
A) an actor.
B) a university student.
C) a musician.

Answer

2) How did Kirsty learn about presenting before she first applied for work as a presenter?
A) She went on a training course far presenters.
B) She spent a lot of time watching presenters on TV.
C) She did an unpaid job for a television company.

Answer

3) What does Kirsty believe is her best skill?
A) interviewing people
B) speaking directly to the camera
C) interacting with an audience

Answer

4) Kirsty delivered the film of herself to the company…
A) by hand.
B) by email.
C) by post.

Answer

5) How did Kirsty feel when the company invited her to do a test?
A) She lost her self-confidence.
B) She became rather nervous.
C) She was extremely pleased.

Answer

6) What did Kirsty find most difficult to learn to do?
A) always remember everything in the script
B) look into the right camera all the time
C) know exactly what the producer wanted her to do

Answer

7) What, according to Kirsty, is the most important quality a presenter should have?
A) the capacity to remain calm under pressure
B) the ability to do their own research
C) a willingness to work as part of a team

Answer

Reading comprehension exercise

You are going to read an article about four people who have become famous in their country. For questions 1-10, choose from the people (A-D). The people may be chosen more than once.

Which person …

sometimes finds that being a celebrity can be expensive?	1/….	1
regrets becoming famous?	2/….	2
suggests the media can be too aggressive with celebrities?	3/….	3
at first found it hard to accept they should set an example for young people?	4/….	4
is pleased that their experience enables them to advise other people?	5/….	5
says that most people would enjoy being celebrities?	6/….	6
believes it is impossible for celebrities to keep anything secret from the media?	7/….	7
accuses some celebrities of thinking they are more important than other people?	8/….	8
says that some famous people are suspicious of other celebrities?	9/….	9
wishes they hadn't said some things in public?	10/….	10

A)

Jake Mackenzie hit the headlines as a teenager when he disappeared while sailing a small boat in the Pacific. He was eventually found safe and well, and instant fame followed. He became a regular guest on TV chat shows and his agent sold the film rights to his story for a considerable sum. “It'd always been my dream to be famous,” said Jake, “though I never imagined it'd happen this way.” Whatever the reason for it, he's certainly enjoying-it: ·”I’m meeting ·some big stars, and I'm doing worthwhile things, too. Such as giving survival tips on TV, which one day might help someone in the situation I was in.” The only disadvantage, he says, is when he's in hotels or taxis: 'I have to leave extra-large tips in case they recognise me. lf not, the next thing I know is that some, tabloid will be calling me "mean", or worse.’

B)

Soap actor **Rachita Patel** began her career in theatre. 'Becoming quite well known happened gradually as the series grew in popularity, and I must admit I'd miss being in the public eye if it all suddenly came to an end. I've made good friends on this show, though one or two of those I work with clearly believe they're in a world where nobody can be trusted, that everyone’s talking behind their back. Maybe it's understandable if they've been given a bad time by the press, with reporters pushing cameras and microphones in their face and shouting really nasty personal questions at them. But they're big stars, and l'm happy as I am. People sometimes recognise me and if they do they might smile, but other times nobody gives me a second glance, and that suits me fine, too.

C)

Winning that gold medal,' says ice-skater **Elka Kaminski**, 'changed my life. Being invited onto TV shows and interviewed by the press was a dream come true, though back then I was totally inexperienced and I now regret one or two of the comments I made to them. I've met a lot of big stars and actually most of them are quite pleasant people, though there are one or two who show off and look down on everyone else. Funnily enough, they tend to be the ones who've achieved nothing in particular, they're just “famous for being famous”. I'd like to -think my success in skating might inspire other kids from poor backgrounds like mine, though I was initially uncomfortable with the idea of being a role model. But in the end, I got used to the idea and I quite like it now.

D)
Singer **Marcos Carvalho** still enjoys performing, though he's convinced he should have remained an unknown in a small town. 'It's a pity I didn't realise sooner that I'm not the sort of person who's comfortable with publicity: I mean, the press will always find out every personal detail about you. I know they're only doing their job, but the reality is there's no privacy at all. Having said that, I wouldn't want to put anyone off the idea of making a name for themselves, because I'm sure for the vast majority it'd be tremendously exciting. It also usually means not having to worry about where your next pay cheque is coming from anymore."

Find the word…

Find words or phrases in the text that mean the following:

1. person invited to appear on a TV or radio programme (A)
2. person whose job is to deal with business for someone else (A)
3. legal permission to make a film of a book (A)
4. being written and talked about in the media (B)
5. devices used to record a voice, or make it louder (B)
6. try to make people admire them, in an annoying way (C)
7. think that someone is less important than them (C)
8. make people feel they want to do something and can do it (C)
9. person who others admire and try to copy (C)
10. information about someone or something in the media (D)
11. right to do things without other people seeing or hearing (D)
12. becoming well known by doing something special (D)

Word formation

For questions 1-8, read the text below. Use the word given in capitals at the end of some of the lines to form a word that fits in the gap in the same line.

Has TV viewing reached its peak?

For over half a century, the (1) _____ in television audiences continued steadily. Now, though, following (2) _____ of a report into the nation's viewing habits, a TV marketing (3) _____ claims this may no longer be the case.	GROW PUBLISH ORGANISE
The report found that last year the average (4) _____ of time spent watching live TV was four hours and two minutes a day, including an average of 46 (5) _____, and although these figures were up on the previous year, the authors of the report believe the rate of increase is now slowing.	LONG ADVERTISE
They point to a (6) _____ of factors, including the economic crisis, to explain the rise in the number of TV (7) _____ since last year, and insist that the long-term trend is downwards.	VARIOUS VIEW
This report, however, ignores the increasingly wide (8) _____ that people now have in the ways they can watch TV, ranging from home computers to mobile phones, and it is my (9) _____ that total viewing figures will keep going up.	CHOOSE BELIEVE

Writing – report

Quick steps to writing a report

- ✓ Decide what the readers of your report will want to know.
- ✓ Make notes on any facts you know about the subject and any persona! experience you may have.
- ✓ Think of a good title that tells readers about the content.
- ✓ Plan your report, including recommendations and suggestions at or near the end.
- ✓ **In your first paragraph, say what the aim of your report is.**
- ✓ Write in an appropriate style for your readers.

Useful expressions:

carry out (a survey)
A key challenge …
The purpose of…
make a recommendation
the next step…
to sum up, …

****

A group of English-speaking young people are planning to visit your town next winter. You have been asked to write a report about the forms of entertainment there and say which kinds of (social) event you think the group might enjoy going to.

Write your report in 140-190 words.

Get ideas for your report by thinking about these questions.

1 What do you know about your local cultural/entertainment scene?
2 Which kinds of event might your visitors enjoy? Why?
3 What would be a good title for your report?

Writing · report: your answer (140-190 words)

Report on entertainment in your town for a group of English-speaking young people.

Title:

Grammar Reference

REPORTED SPEECH

Rewrite these sentences in the direct speech.

a) He said he had a guest whose voice would be familiar.

b) She said that sitting there being asked all those questions was making her nervous.

c) She said it had happened recently, and that the week before her guest had suddenly walked out.

Look at the verbs in the sentences. How do these tenses change in reported speech?

present simple
will future
present continuous
present perfect
past simple

How have these words changed in the reported speech?

I here these me last week my

Change the sentences to reported speech.

1. 'I don't want to watch this programme now,' said Jaime.
2. 'I'm going out when my boyfriend gets here,' Louise told me over the phone.
3. 'I saw the match at my friend's house last night,' Joey said on Monday.
4. 'Later this evening I'll be talking to my favourite TV star,' my sister said.
5. 'I'd been working in entertainment ever since I left school,' Anna told the presenter.
6. 'I've always wanted to be on TV, and tomorrow I will be,' said Julia.

Complete the sentences with these **reporting verbs**.

admit **apologise** **offer** **suggest** **tell**

1 Paul _____ to lend me his copy of the DVD.
2 Leena _____ that we should watch TV.
3 A police officer _____ the man not to move.
4 I _____ for losing the TV remote control.
5 Two youths _____ stealing the satellite dish.

Put the reporting verbs above into the correct group, a, b, c, d or e. Some verbs can go into more than one group. Then do the same with these verbs.

advise	decide	deny	explain	threaten
insist	invite	order	persuade	warn
promise	recommend	refuse	remind	

Verbs followed by:

a	to	offer, …	
b	object + to	tell (sb), …	
c	-ing		
d	(that) + clause		
e	preposition + -ing		

Rewrite the following from the text in reported speech:

1 'I never imagined it'd happen this way.'
Jack said _____
2 'I'm meeting some big stars, and I'm doing worthwhile things, too.'
_____
3 'I have to leave extra-large tips in case they recognise me.'
_____
4 'I've made good friends on this show.'
_____
5 'I'm happy as I am.'
_____
6 'Winning that gold medal changed my life.'
_____
7 'It's a pity I didn't realise sooner.'
_____
8 'The press will always find out every persona! detail.'
_____

Complete the second sentence so that it has a similar meaning to the first sentence, using the word given. Do not change the word given. You must use between two and five words, including the word given.

'I won't listen to you ever again,' my sister said to me.
REFUSED
My sister _____ ever again.

'Don't forget to bring your pens,' the teacher said to us.
REMINDED
The teacher _____ pens.

'Would you like to meet my parents, Jo?' said Rosa.
INVITED
Rosa _____ parents.

'I've done nothing wrong,' the man said when he was arrested.
DENIED
The man _____ when he was arrested.

'I don't think you should go there on your own,' Abigail's mother said.
AGAINST
Abigail's mother _____ there on her own.

'Let's go this way home,' said Jay as we left the club.
SUGGESTED
Jay _____ home as we left the club.